Connor Aird

Research Software Engineer at UCL
London, United Kingdom

Skills

- C++, Fortran, Python
- Docker, Git, Qt, Quarto
- MPI, OpenMP

Education

09/2016 - 06/2020

MPhys Physics
University of York
1st Class Honours (with distinction)

Awards

2026

CAKE Fellowship
Awarded funding for developing and delivering Fortran Unit Testing workshops across the UK

2026

Qualified Carpentries Instructor
Experience teaching UNIX shell, Python, Git and Fortran

Contact

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Experience

Research Software Engineer — 08/2024 - Present
Centre for Advanced Research Computing
University College London
Beyond my Assistant RSE responsibilities, I now manage projects including staffing and PI collaboration. I develop and deliver workshop training materials, and regularly present at conferences such as RSECon and FOSDEM.

Assitant Research Software Engineer — 06/2023 - 08/2024
Centre for Advanced Research Computing
University College London
Collaborated with researchers across UCL to design, develop, improve and maintain research codes, advised on software best practices, and supported Carpentries teaching and marking.

Consultant — 08/2020 - 06/2023
Accenture
Leeds, UK
Built well-tested web applications, wrote AWS infrastructure-as-code using Terraform and maintained CI/CD pipelines with Jenkins and GitHub Actions.

Projects

GLASS, Porting to the python array API — 09/2025 - Present
RSE, UCL
Ported existing functions utilising NumPy, within this Python codebase, to be array api compatible and created a benchmark suite using pytest benchmark.

k-Plan Treatment Planning Module — 07/2023 - Present
RSE, UCL
Schedule staffing on the project, Prioritse work, Implement feature requests, bug fixes and general maintenance and advise on implementation and design.

MUSIC, DiRAC GPU feasibility study — 04/2025 - 06/2025
RSE, UCL
Aimed to determine the potential gains and likely cost of GPU offloading the MUSIC codebase. Produced scripts for building and generating benchmark data for MUSIC. Also profiled MUSIC using the NVIDIA NSIGHT system.

CONQUEST, eCSE08 Improving Multi-threaded Scaling. — 01/2024 - 06/2024
RSE, UCL
Refactored a kernel within this Fortran code to maximise serial performance, implemented OpenMP and BLAS parallelisation and carried out performance analysis using benchmarks and profilers to tune this parallel implementation.

Professional Development

02/2026	Fortran Course	Developed and instructed my own course on unit testing Fortran.
10/2025 - Present	TechSocials	Organiser of the TechSocials series.
09/2024 - Present	Fortran collaboration	Fortran community collaboration (grant applications, hackathons, etc)